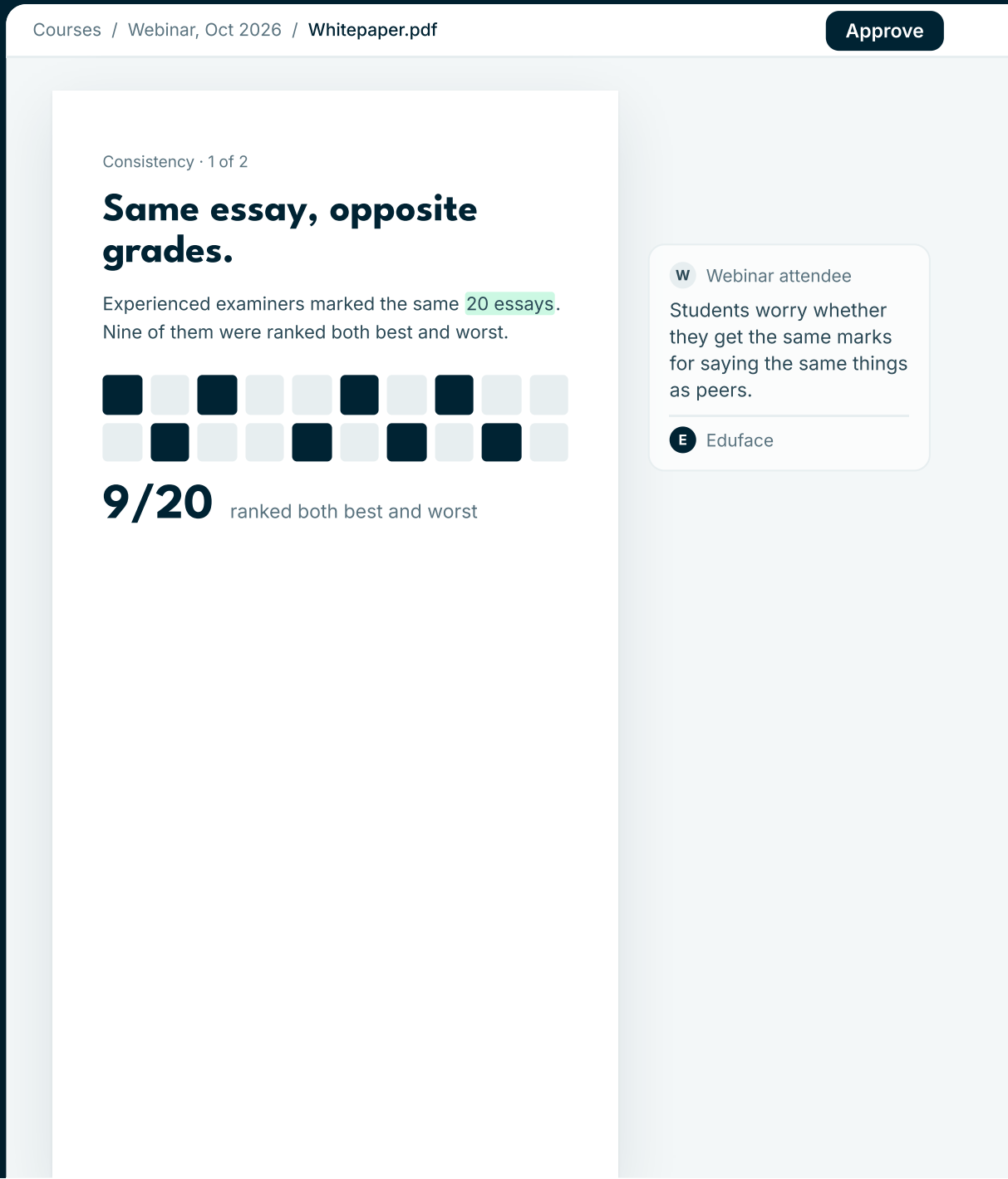
Whitepaper · October 2026

The business outcomes of AI marking and feedback

Consistency and operational efficiency, from 20+ implementations.

Eduface



Two outcomes, from 20+ implementations.

Institutions bring in AI marking and feedback for many reasons. The results we can measure come down to two: consistency and operational efficiency.

Consistency pages 3 to 4

Students are judged on their work, not on who marked it.

Definition

Every paper is marked against the same criteria in the same way: the same mark, the same focus and the same style of feedback, whoever marks it.

9/20 essays ranked both best and worst by experienced examiners

Operational efficiency pages 5 to 6

Lecturer time moves from typing feedback to teaching.

Definition

Less staff time per assignment for the same or better feedback, while the lecturer still approves every comment and every mark.

−85% time spent typing feedback, up to 20 minutes per assignment

Consistency · 1 of 2

Eduface

Same essay, opposite grades.

24 experienced examiners from 20 UK universities marked the same 20 essays.
Nine were ranked among both the best and the worst.

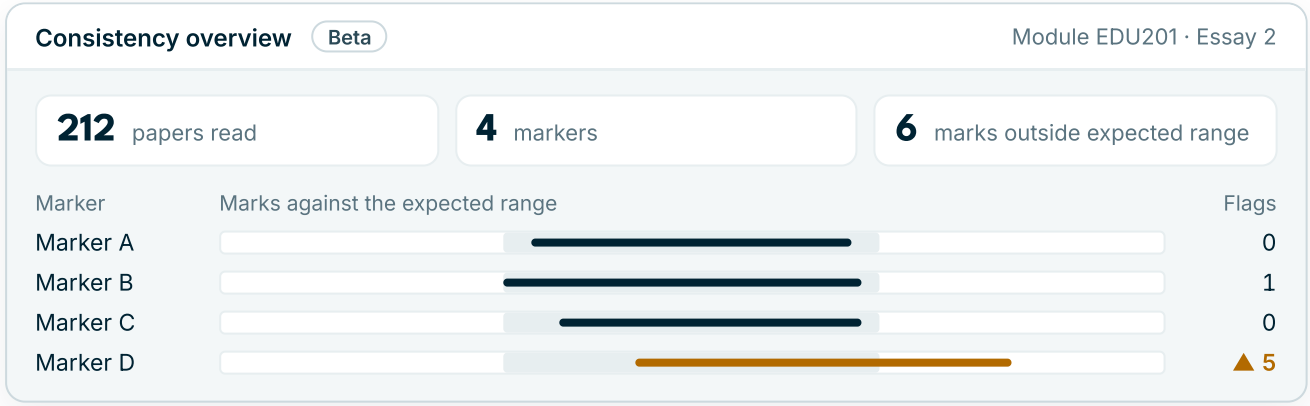


9/20 essays ranked both best and worst

Many markers, one module
Each marker reads the rubric a little differently.

Paper 80 is not paper 5
The same marker marks the eightieth paper differently from the fifth.

Moderation sees a sample
The other papers are never compared.



W Webinar attendee

Students worry whether they get the same marks for saying the same things as peers who were marked by someone else.

E Eduface

This is consistency as students feel it.

W Webinar attendee

Why should complete consistency be the ideal in an activity that relies on expert judgement?

E Eduface

It shouldn't be. Consistency means the same criteria are applied. Markers can still disagree, and the consistency overview shows where they do.

↓ Consistency overview

Bloxham et al., Assessment & Evaluation in Higher Education, 2016. Consistency overview: illustrative screen, fictional data, in beta.

Consistency · 2 of 2 Beta

Eduface

Every paper read. No AI grade shown.

Not ready for AI grades? The consistency check, now in beta, reads every paper in the background and flags marks outside the expected range. The marker keeps the mark, and the AI grade stays hidden.

Submission	Your mark	AI grade	Consistency signal
#1042	65	Hidden	–
#1043	58	Hidden	–
#1044	72	Hidden	–
#1045	41	Hidden	▲ Outside expected range
#1046	67	Hidden	–

A spreadsheet

Compares marks with marks.

A 41 looks low next to a 65. It can't tell if the paper deserved it.

The consistency check

Compares the mark with the paper.

A 41 on a weak paper stays quiet. A 41 on a strong paper gets flagged.

E Eduface · how the check works

1. It analyses every submission in the background, while the marker marks as usual.

E Eduface · how the check works

2. It only raises a signal when a mark falls outside the expected range for that paper.

E Eduface · how the check works

3. It never shows an AI grade, never changes a mark and makes no decision. It can add comments, if you want them.

Illustrative screen, fictional data. The consistency check is in beta and not yet generally available.

Bad AI feedback costs more time than no AI.

Fixing inaccurate feedback is slower than writing your own. Accuracy is the business case, and tuning the model to your rubric is the investment that pays for it.



Time per assignment. Illustration, not a measurement.

94%

average accuracy, 435 submissions and 13 markers

98%

for markers who tuned the model to their rubric

−85%

time spent typing feedback, up to 20 minutes per assignment

W Webinar attendee

Could or should we trust the statistical probability of an AI model?

E Eduface

Not blindly. Measure it against your own markers first. That is what these numbers are.

Accuracy is how close the AI's grade proposal is to the marker's own grade, on average. It is not a match rate. Accuracy measured in one of our implementations, typing time across our implementations.

Operational efficiency · 2 of 2

Eduface

The AI drafts. The lecturer decides.

Time is saved on writing, not on judging. Nothing reaches the student without the lecturer, and every edit is logged.

AI drafts
A comment per rubric criterion

→

Lecturer decides
Approves, edits or adds

→

Student receives
Only approved feedback

97%

of summative assignments get extra feedback from the lecturer, on top of the AI draft. Lecturers don't outsource their judgement.

A nudge against rubber-stamping



After a long run of drafts approved untouched, the platform asks the lecturer a question about one specific assignment.

Edit rate: Eduface implementations.

E Eduface

Students only ever see feedback their lecturer approved.

Next step

Eduface

Start small. Then roll out what works.

Jisc's advice to institutions starting with AI in assessment: begin small, with a pilot. It matches what we have learned across 20+ implementations.



Phase 1

A small group

A few lecturers, one module, one use case. The model is tuned to their rubric.

Phase 2

Proven use cases

What worked moves to more modules and more markers.

Phase 3

Gradual roll-out

The next use cases are added one at a time, when the institution is ready.

Where institutions often start

The consistency check on a module that is already marked Beta

AI-drafted formative feedback on one assignment

> **We have experience starting small and deliberately with a smaller group, and rolling out the use cases an institution wants step by step.**

W Webinar attendee

I'm sure there is something to investigate here, but it's not straightforward.

E Eduface

Agreed. That is why we start small.